Ridley Road Market

1 Ridley Road Market is in Dalston, a short walk from Dalston Kingsland station. It is one of the oldest street markets in Hackney. Every morning, traders set up their stalls along the narrow street.

2 You can buy fresh fruit and vegetables, fish, meat, colourful fabrics and cheap things for the kitchen. Many stalls sell food from Africa, the Caribbean and Turkey, so it is a good place to find ingredients from home.

3 The market is busy and noisy. Traders shout loudly to tell people about their prices, and music comes from some of the shops. Prices are usually lower than in the supermarket, especially at the end of the day, when traders want to sell everything quickly.

4 Bring cash, because some small stalls do not take cards. Go early if you want the best fish. Walk carefully when it rains – the ground can be slippery.

Questions

Answer on your own first. Then check with your group and find the line in the text that proves each answer.

1. How can you get to the market by train? Write the name of the station.

_____

2. Why is the market good for people from other countries?

A It is near a station.
B They can buy things to cook food from their country.
C It is open every morning.
D It is very quiet.

3. When are things usually cheapest?

A early in the morning B when it rains C late in the day D at the weekend

4. Why should you take money in notes and coins?

A Some sellers can’t take payment by card.
B Cards are not safe at the market.
C Cash is cheaper than cards.
D There is no bank in Dalston.

5. Write two things you can buy at the market.

1. _____

2. _____

Now write the answers for your place in your row of the grid.

London Fields and the Lido

1 London Fields is a large green park between Hackney Central and Broadway Market. On sunny days it is full of people. Families have picnics on the grass, children play happily in the playground, and friends play football or table tennis. There is also a special area where you can have a barbecue.

2 At one side of the park is London Fields Lido, an outdoor swimming pool. It is 50 metres long and the water is heated, so people swim there all year – even in December! The lido is not free, and on busy days it is a good idea to book online. If you are not a strong swimmer, use the slow lane and swim calmly.

3 The park is free and open every day. In winter it gets dark early, so walk home with a friend in the evening.

Questions

Answer on your own first. Then check with your group and find the line in the text that proves each answer.

1. What can families do in the park?

A swim for free
B eat a meal outside on the grass
C buy fresh fish
D go on a boat

2. Why can people swim at the lido in winter?

A The pool is inside a building.
B The water is made warm.
C The pool is free.
D The pool is 50 metres long.

3. You don’t have to pay to use the lido. True or false?

A True B False

4. What should you do on a busy day?

A arrive in the evening
B reserve a place on the internet
C swim in the fast lane
D bring a friend

5. Write two sports or games people play in London Fields.

1. _____

2. _____

Now write the answers for your place in your row of the grid.

Broadway Market

1 Broadway Market is a street near London Fields and the Regent's Canal. During the week it is a quiet street with small shops, cafés and a bookshop. But every Saturday it changes completely. More than a hundred stalls fill the road, and thousands of people come from all over London.

2 The Saturday market is famous for food. You can buy fresh bread, cheese, cakes and flowers, or eat hot food from many different countries. The food is delicious, but it is often expensive – a coffee and a cake can cost eight or nine pounds. If you want to save money, walk slowly along the street first and look at all the prices before you buy.

3 The market gets very crowded after eleven o'clock, so try to arrive early. It is a nice walk from London Fields, and you can sit by the canal to eat.

Questions

Answer on your own first. Then check with your group and find the line in the text that proves each answer.

1. What is the street like from Monday to Friday?

A full of people
B calm, with a few small shops
C very expensive
D full of stalls

2. On which day of the week is the big market?

_____

3. What does the text say about the food?

A It is cheap.
B It tastes very good but costs a lot.
C It all comes from England.
D You can only buy cakes.

4. How can you save money?

A Go after eleven o'clock.
B Check the prices of all the stalls first.
C Only buy coffee.
D Eat by the canal.

5. Write two things you can buy at the Saturday market.

1. _____
2. _____

Now write the answers for your place in your row of the grid.

The Regent’s Canal

1 The Regent’s Canal runs through Hackney, past Broadway Market and Victoria Park. Next to the water there is a path, called the towpath, where you can walk or ride a bike. It is free and open all the time, and it is one of the most peaceful places in the borough.

2 On the canal you will see narrowboats – long, thin boats painted in bright colours. Some people live on these boats all year. You will also see ducks, swans and sometimes a heron standing very still in the water.

3 The towpath is narrow, so be polite. Cyclists should ride slowly and ring their bell when they come up behind people. Walkers should keep to one side. Do not feed bread to the ducks – it is bad for them. On a sunny afternoon, it is lovely to walk all the way from Hackney to Islington.

Questions

Answer on your own first. Then check with your group and find the line in the text that proves each answer.

1. What can you do on the towpath?

A swim B walk or cycle C buy food D drive a car

2. Which sentence is correct?

A All the boats are grey.
B Some people’s homes are on the canal.
C The towpath is very wide.
D You must pay to use the towpath.

3. What should cyclists do?

A go fast
B go at a low speed and use their bell
C ride in the middle of the path
D get off and walk

4. Why should you not give bread to the ducks?

A It is expensive.
B It is unhealthy for them.
C The swans eat it.
D It is not allowed on Sundays.

5. Write two birds you can see on the canal.

1. _____

2. _____

Now write the answers for your place in your row of the grid.